

The report

Present findings and recommend action

Word count ~250 or ~400 words	Register Formal, objective, neutral	Title Subject line + section headings	Structure Header + sections
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STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Date: — [date]

From: — [your name / role]

Subject: — [clear, descriptive title]

Introduction — ~50–80 words – state purpose and data source

Section + heading — ~50–80 words – main point 1, under its own heading

Section + heading — ~50–80 words – main point 2, under its own heading

Conclusion / Recommendations — ~50–80 words – summarise + suggest action

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Present and analyse facts, not personal opinions
- Be neutral, concise, and to the point
- Use the passive voice where appropriate
- Include specific data when referencing surveys/statistics – you may invent realistic figures
- End with clear recommendations or suggestions
- Make it the most visually organised text on your paper
- Use linking words to show language proficiency

DON'T

- Don't give personal opinions in the main body
- Don't repeat information across sections
- Don't write anything that isn't relevant
- Don't forget the Date / From / Subject header
- Don't forget section headings
- Don't use emotional or informal language

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

I really think the school canteen is terrible and nobody likes it.

STRONGER

Under heading 2, Findings: 68 per cent of the 120 students surveyed rated the canteen food as poor or very poor.

Why it matters. A report stays factual and impersonal and presents its evidence under clear headings. Personal outbursts cost you marks for register and task achievement.

KEY TIP

Key tip. The report is the most visually distinctive text type. Examiners notice the headings immediately. Every section needs one, no exceptions.

USEFUL PHRASES

Introduction

- As requested, I have prepared a report on...
- The aim of this report is to...
- This report examines/compares...
- The data was collected through...

Presenting data

- Twenty per cent of the people asked...
- The majority of respondents...
- One in five stated that...
- It is generally felt that...
- A large proportion of those interviewed...

Conclusion / Recommendations

- On the basis of these findings,...
- I would therefore recommend/suggest that...
- It would seem that... is the best option.
- In view of this, one can recommend...
- It would also be advisable to...

MODEL TEXT

Survey Results - Student Stress Levels (~250 words · Formal · actual count 250)

Date: 15 March 2026

From: Anna Gruber, Student Council

Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels

Introduction

This report presents the findings of a survey on stress levels conducted among 85 students in years 5 and 6. The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures. The survey was carried out anonymously over a two-week period in February and consisted of ten questions on workload, sleep and support services.

Key Findings

The majority of respondents (72%) reported feeling stressed on a regular basis. Exams and homework deadlines were identified as the primary sources of pressure. In addition, 45% mentioned sleep problems connected to school-related anxiety. Only 18% were aware of the school's existing counselling services. When asked about the timing of stress, students pointed clearly to the weeks before exams. Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys, although both groups named similar causes.

Recommendations

On the basis of these findings, I would recommend introducing a weekly "no-homework day" and promoting the counselling service through posters and assemblies. It would also be advisable to schedule exams more evenly across the term to reduce pressure peaks. Finally, teachers could be encouraged to coordinate test dates through a shared online calendar so that deadlines do not pile up in the same week.

Conclusion

In summary, stress is widespread among younger students and is closely linked to exams and homework. If these recommendations are put into practice, the school could noticeably improve both student wellbeing and academic results.

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The marked features, in reading order:

Header - Date, From, Subject all required — "Date: 15 March 2026"

From: Anna Gruber, Student Council

Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels"

Section heading — "Introduction"

States purpose of report — "The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures."

Passive - objective method — "carried out anonymously"

Report language - cite data precisely — "The majority of respondents (72%)"

Passive voice - objective tone — "were identified as"

B2 linking word — "In addition,"

Precise reporting of data — "Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys"

Every section gets its own heading — "Recommendations"

Conclusion linker for reports — "On the basis of these findings,"

Recommendation - required in every report — "I would recommend"

Formal suggestion phrase — "It would also be advisable to"

Optional final section — "Conclusion"

Conditional - formal close — "If these recommendations are put into practice"

More online. This text type also has a second model text on the website ("Report on the use of the school library", ~250 words · formal) and an annotated "honest model" that shows a realistic borderline text. matura.bernhardgmeiner.com